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Inventor(s)	Dumaplin; Cara

Swaddle blanket

Abstract

A swaddle blanket and band are described. The blanket and band may be used alone or in combination. The blanket and band may utilize panels of hook and loop fasteners (e.g., silent hook and loop fasteners) that may be sewn onto a base fabric to allow for ease of swaddling. In addition, the blanket may utilize a strap that folds and attaches to itself to form a loop to secure a lower portion of the blanket and provide size adjustability/remove excess slack.

Inventors:	Dumaplin; Cara (Glendale, AZ)
Applicant:	Dumaplin; Cara (Glendale, AZ)
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Primary Examiner: Santos; Robert G

Background/Summary

BACKGROUND

Technical Field

(1) The present invention relates to swaddle blankets.

Background of the Invention

(2) Swaddle blankets are known in the art. Examples include those described in U.S. Pat. Nos. 7,774,875, 11,622,585 and 9,131,734.

(3) There is a continuing need for comfortable swaddle blankets that are versatile, promote sleep, are easy to use, and do not disturb the child.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

(1) FIG. 1 illustrates rear and front elevation views of a band and a front elevation view of a swaddle blanket in accordance with one embodiment of the present invention; in particular the top drawing is a rear view of the band, the middle drawing is a front view of the band, and the bottom drawing is a front view of the swaddle blanket with dashed lines to show how the band removably attaches to the swaddle blanket.

(2) FIGS. 2-11 and FIG. 11A illustrate, in a stepwise manner, how the band and swaddle blanket of FIG. 1 may be used to swaddle a child.

(3) FIGS. 12-17 illustrate, in a stepwise manner, how the swaddle blanket of FIG. 1 may be used without the band to swaddle a child.

(4) FIGS. 18-23 illustrate, in a stepwise manner, how the band of FIG. 1 may be used without the swaddle blanket to swaddle a child.

(5) FIGS. 24-25 illustrate front elevation views of the band of FIG. 1.

(6) FIG. 26 illustrates a rear elevation view of the band of FIG. 1.

(7) FIG. 27 illustrates a front elevation view of the swaddle blanket of FIG. 1.

(8) FIG. 28 illustrates a rear elevation view of the swaddle blanket of FIG. 1.

(9) FIG. 29 illustrates a front perspective view of the swaddle blanket of FIG. 1.

(10) FIG. 30 illustrates a rear perspective view of the swaddle blanket of FIG. 1.

(11) FIG. 31 illustrates a front elevation view of a swaddle blanket in accordance with another embodiment of the present invention.

(12) FIG. 32 illustrates a rear elevation view of the swaddle blanket of FIG. 31.

SUMMARY OF THE INVENTION

(13) In some embodiments, the present disclosure provides a swaddle blanket as described herein.

(14) In some embodiments, the swaddle blanket comprises a blanket body that may comprise a) a blanket front; b) a blanket rear; c) a blanket thickness extending from the blanket front to the blanket rear; d) a blanket top; e) a blanket bottom; f) a blanket height extending from the blanket top to the blanket bottom and perpendicular to the blanket thickness; g) a blanket left side; h) a blanket right side; i) a blanket width extending from the blanket left side to the blanket right side and perpendicular to the blanket height and blanket thickness; j) one or more base fabric panels that may comprise a front forming a portion of the blanket front and a rear forming a portion of the blanket rear; k) a plurality of female fastener panels sewn to the one or more base fabric panels, optionally wherein at least some of the female fastener panels comprise a front forming a portion of the blanket front and comprising loop fasteners; and/or l) a plurality of male fastener panels that may be sewn to the one or more base fabric panels, optionally wherein at least some of the male fastener panels comprise a rear forming a portion of the blanket rear and comprising hook fasteners configured to releasably attach to the loop fasteners. Optionally, the blanket left side is foldable relative to the blanket right side to allow the blanket body to wrap

around and swaddle a child. Optionally, the hook fasteners and loop fasteners are silent hook and loop fasteners. The portions of the blanket rear that are aligned heightwise and widthwise with the female fastener panel fronts do not include a hook or loop fastener and the portions of the blanket front that are aligned heightwise and widthwise with the male fastener panel rears do not include a hook or loop fastener. Optionally, for each female fastener panel, the respective loop fastener covers substantially all of the female fastener panel front, and wherein for each male fastener panel, the respective hook fastener covers substantially all of the male fastener panel rear. Optionally, the right side of the blanket front comprises an upper female fastener panel comprising a front comprising a loop fastener, a middle female fastener panel located below the upper female fastener panel and comprising a front comprising a loop fastener, and a lower female fastener panel located below the middle female fastener panel and comprising a front comprising a loop fastener. Optionally, the left side of the blanket rear comprises an upper male fastener panel aligned vertically with the upper female fastener panel and comprising a rear comprising a hook fastener, a middle male fastener panel located below the upper male fastener panel and aligned vertically with the middle female fastener panel and comprising a rear comprising a hook fastener, and a lower male fastener panel located below the middle male fastener panel and aligned vertically with the lower female fastener panel and comprising a rear comprising a hook fastener. Optionally, the upper female fastener panel is the same size and shape as the upper male fastener panel, wherein the middle female fastener panel is the same size and shape as the middle male fastener panel, and further wherein the lower female fastener panel is the same size and shape as the lower male fastener panel. Optionally, the blanket front further comprises a center female fastener panel located between the upper female fastener panel and the upper male fastener panel and comprising a front comprising a loop fastener. Optionally, the swaddle blanket further comprises a removable rectangular band comprising a rear comprising a hook fastener configured to releasably attach to the loop fastener of the center female fastener panel. Optionally, the one or more base fabrics is located between the upper female fastener panel and the middle female fastener panel, and between the middle female fastener panel and the lower female fastener panel. Optionally, the width of the upper female fastener panel is greater than the width of the middle female fastener panel and further wherein the width of the middle female fastener panel is greater than the width of the lower female fastener panel. Optionally, the height of the upper female fastener panel is greater than the height of the middle female fastener panel and/or the height of the lower female fastener panel is greater than the height of the middle female fastener panel. Optionally, the base fabric panel is comprised of modal fabric. Optionally, the male fastener panel rear is comprised of velvet. Optionally, the female fastener panel front is comprised of loop fabric. Optionally, the swaddle blanket further comprises a strap located adjacent the blanket bottom and comprising a strap front comprising a strap front fastener, a strap rear comprising a strap rear fastener configured to releasably attach to the strap front fastener, a strap thickness extending from the strap front to the strap rear and parallel to the blanket thickness, a strap left side, a strap right side, a strap width extending from the strap left side to the strap right side and perpendicular to the strap thickness, a strap top, a strap bottom, and a strap height extending from the strap top to the strap bottom and perpendicular to the strap width and the strap thickness and parallel to the blanket height. Optionally, the strap is configured to transition from a flat position in which the strap is flat to a looped position in which the strap removably folds around itself and the strap front fastener attaches to the strap rear fastener so that the strap forms a loop. Optionally, the strap front fastener is a loop fastener and further wherein the strap rear fastener is a hook fastener. Optionally, one of the strap front and the strap rear consist of loop fabric and the other of the strap front and the strap rear consist of hook fabric and further wherein the loop fabric is sewn to the hook fabric. Optionally, the strap front fastener covers the strap front and/or the strap rear fastener covers the strap rear. Optionally, the strap rear is located to the rear of the blanket rear in the flat position and in the looped position. Optionally, the strap width is greater than the strap height. Optionally, the strap is located below the blanket bottom and further wherein the strap width is greater than the blanket width at the blanket bottom. Optionally, the strap width is from about 5 inches to about 10 inches and the strap height is from about 0.5 inches to about 2 inches. Optionally, the blanket width is variable and comprises a maximum width of between about 25 inches and about 35 inches. Optionally, the blanket is symmetrical about a longitudinal axis extending from a widthwise center of the blanket top to a widthwise center of the blanket bottom, said longitudinal axis parallel to the blanket height. Optionally, the blanket height is between about 25 inches and about 35 inches. Optionally, the blanket thickness is between about 0.001 inches and about 0.5 inches. Optionally, the blanket front does not have any hook fasteners and the blanket rear does not have any loop fasteners. Optionally, one or more of the of loop fasteners is aligned along the blanket height with a hook fastener (fasteners are aligned vertically). Optionally, the swaddle blanket further comprises a removable rectangular band comprising a rear comprising a first hook fastener and a second hook fastener, the second hook fastener configured to releasably attach to a blanket loop fastener. Optionally, the removable rectangular band comprises a front comprising a loop fastener configured to releasably attach to the first hook fastener. Optionally, the swaddle blanket comprises a middle segment located between the blanket top and blanket bottom, and further wherein the blanket width at the middle segment is greater than the blanket width at the blanket top and blanket bottom. Optionally, the blanket width at the blanket top is greater than the blanket width at the blanket bottom. Optionally, the blanket width is variable (due to the panels).

(15) Optionally, the swaddle blanket is used in a method of using a swaddle blanket comprising the steps of: a) providing the swaddle blanket; b) placing a child on the blanket body; and c) wrapping the swaddle blanket around the child. Optionally, the method further comprises: d) releasably attaching at least one male fastener panel to at least one female fastener panel. Optionally, the swaddle blanket further comprises a strap located adjacent the blanket bottom and comprising a strap front comprising a strap front fastener, a strap rear comprising a strap rear fastener configured to releasably attach to the strap front fastener, a strap thickness extending from the strap front to the strap rear and parallel to the blanket thickness, a strap left side, a strap right side, and a strap width extending from the strap left side to the strap right side and perpendicular to the strap thickness, a strap top, a strap bottom, and a strap height extending from the strap top to the strap bottom and perpendicular to the strap width and the strap thickness and parallel to the blanket height. Optionally, the strap is configured to transition from a flat position in which the strap is flat to a looped position in which the strap removably folds around itself and the strap front fastener attaches to the strap rear fastener so that the strap forms a loop located in front of the blanket front and/or located to the rear of the blanket rear; and the method further comprises e) attaching the strap front fastener to the strap rear fastener. Optionally, the method further comprises the step of folding the blanket bottom upwards towards the blanket top before step e).

(16) In still further embodiments, the present disclosure provides a swaddle blanket that may comprise a) a blanket body that may comprise i) a blanket front that may comprise a plurality of blanket female fasteners; ii) a blanket rear that may comprise a plurality of blanket male fasteners configured to releasably attach to the blanket female fasteners; iii) a blanket thickness extending from the blanket front to the blanket rear; iv) a blanket top; v) a blanket bottom; vi) a blanket height extending from the blanket top to the blanket bottom and perpendicular to the blanket thickness; vii) a blanket left side; viii) a blanket right side; and/or ix) a blanket width extending from the blanket left side to the blanket right side and perpendicular to the blanket height and blanket thickness. The swaddle blanket may also include b) a strap that may be located adjacent the blanket bottom and may comprise a strap front comprising a strap front fastener, a strap rear comprising a strap rear fastener configured to releasably attach to the strap front fastener, a strap thickness extending from the strap front to the strap rear and parallel to the blanket thickness, a strap left side, a strap right side, a strap width extending from the strap left side to the strap right side and perpendicular to the strap thickness, a strap top, a strap bottom, and a strap height extending from the strap top to the strap bottom and perpendicular to the strap width and the strap thickness and parallel to the blanket height. Optionally, the blanket left side is foldable relative to the blanket right side to allow the blanket body to wrap around and swaddle a child. Optionally, the strap is configured to transition from a flat position in which the strap is flat to a looped position in which the strap removably folds around itself and the strap front fastener attaches to the strap rear fastener so that the strap forms a loop. The swaddle blanket may include one or more features described above, in any combination. For example, optionally, the swaddle blanket is comprised of one or more base fabric panels sewn to a) a plurality of male fastener panels and b) a plurality of female fastener panels, and optionally, further wherein each female fastener panel comprises i) a female fastener panel front comprising a blanket female fastener and forming a portion of the blanket front; and ii) a male fastener panel comprising a male fastener panel rear comprising a blanket male fastener and forming a portion of the blanket rear. Optionally, the portions of

the blanket rear that are aligned heightwise and widthwise with the female fastener panel fronts do not include a hook or loop fastener and further wherein the portions of the blanket front that are aligned heightwise and widthwise with the male fastener panel rears do not include a hook or loop fastener. Optionally, for each female fastener panel, the respective blanket female fastener covers substantially all of the female fastener panel front, and wherein for each male fastener panel, the respective male fastener covers substantially all of the male fastener panel rear. Optionally, the right side of the blanket front comprises an upper female fastener panel comprising a front comprising a blanket female fastener, a middle female fastener panel located below the upper female fastener panel and comprising a front comprising a blanket female fastener, and a lower female fastener panel located below the middle female fastener panel and comprising a front comprising a blanket female fastener. Optionally, the left side of the blanket rear comprises an upper male fastener panel aligned vertically with the upper female fastener panel and comprising a rear comprising a blanket male fastener, a middle male fastener panel located below the upper male fastener panel and aligned vertically with the middle female fastener panel and comprising a rear comprising a blanket male fastener, and a lower male fastener panel located below the middle male fastener panel and aligned vertically with the lower female fastener panel and comprising a rear comprising a blanket male fastener. Optionally, the upper female fastener panel is the same size and shape as the upper male fastener panel, wherein the middle female fastener panel is the same size and shape as the middle male fastener panel, and further wherein the lower female fastener panel is the same size and shape as the lower male fastener panel. Optionally, the blanket further comprises a center female fastener panel located between the upper female fastener panel and the upper male fastener panel and comprising a front comprising a blanket female fastener. Optionally, the swaddle blanket further comprises a removable rectangular band comprising a rear comprising a male band attachment fastener configured to releasably attach to the blanket female fastener of the center female fastener panel. Optionally, the one or more base fabrics is located between the upper female fastener panel and the middle female fastener panel and between the middle female fastener panel and the lower female fastener panel. Optionally, the width of the upper female fastener panel is greater than the width of the middle female fastener panel and further wherein the width of the middle female fastener panel is greater than the width of the lower female fastener panel. Optionally, the height of the upper female fastener panel is greater than the height of the middle female fastener panel and/or the height of the lower female fastener panel is greater than the height of the middle female fastener panel. Optionally, the strap front fastener is a female fastener and further wherein the strap rear fastener is a male fastener. Optionally, the base fabric panel is comprised of modal fabric. Optionally, the male fastener panel rear is comprised of velvet. Optionally the blanket female fastener panel front is comprised of loop fabric.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

(17) Certain preferred embodiments are shown in FIGS. 1-32 of the drawings where a swaddle blanket is generally designated by the numeral **10** and the band is generally designated by the numeral **80**. It will be understood that variations of the apparatuses shown in the illustrations are possible and that features can be combined in any suitable combination. The drawings are generally drawn to scale. However, other dimensions are possible. It will be appreciated that the swaddle blanket **10** and band **80** may assume different orientations in use.

(18) As shown in FIGS. 1-32, three exemplary methods of use are shown. More particularly, as shown in FIGS. 1-11A, the blanket **10** and band **80** may be used together with the band **80** optionally attaching to the blanket **10**. As shown in FIGS. 12-17 and 27-32, the blanket **10** may be used without the band **80**. And as shown in FIGS. 18-26, the band **80** may be used without the blanket **10**.

(19) The blanket **10** and band **80** may use any combination of features described herein. For example, as described below, the blanket **10** and band **80** may utilize panels **70a-d** and **74a-c** of hook and loop fasteners **16** and **20** (e.g., silent hook and loop fasteners) that may be sewn onto a base fabric panel **62** to allow for ease of swaddling and provide a fastening mechanism. In addition, as shown in FIGS. 10-11 and 16-17, the blanket **80** may utilize a strap **36** that folds and attaches to itself (e.g., using mating loop and hook fasteners to form a loop) to secure a lower portion of the blanket **10** and provide size adjustability/remove excess slack at the lower portion of the blanket **10**.

(20) In some embodiments, as shown in FIGS. 1-32, the swaddle blanket **10** may comprise a blanket body **12**, which may comprise one or more of the following: a) a blanket front **14**; b) a blanket rear **18**; c) a blanket thickness **22** extending from the blanket front **14** to the blanket rear **18**; d) a blanket top **24**; e) a blanket bottom **26**; f) a blanket height **28** extending from the blanket top **24** to the blanket bottom **26** and perpendicular to the blanket thickness **22**; g) a blanket left side **30**; h) a blanket right side **32**; and/or i) a blanket width **34** extending from the blanket left side **30** to the blanket right side **32** and perpendicular to the blanket height **28** and blanket thickness **22**. In some embodiments, the blanket rear **18** and blanket front **14** comprise mating blanket male and female fasteners **20** and **16** (e.g., mating hook and loop fasteners) that allow the swaddle blanket **10** to secure to itself as it wraps around a child **60**, as shown in FIGS. 1-32. For example, in some embodiments, as shown in FIGS. 1-32, the blanket body **12** may further comprise: j) one or more base fabric panels **62** that may comprise a front **64** forming a portion of the blanket front **14** and/or a rear **66** forming a portion of the blanket rear **18**; k) a plurality of female fastener panels **68a-d** sewn to the one or more base fabric panels **62**; and/or l) a plurality of male fastener panels **74a-c** sewn to the one or more base fabric panels **62**. Optionally, as shown in FIGS. 1-32, at least some of the female fastener panels **68a-d** comprise a front **70a-d** that may form a portion of the blanket front **14** and may comprise blanket female fasteners **16** (e.g., loop fasteners). Optionally, as shown in FIGS. 1-32, at least some of the male fastener panels **74a-c** comprise a rear **78a-c** that may form a portion of the blanket rear **18** and may comprise male fasteners **20** (e.g., hook fasteners) configured to releasably attach to the female fasteners **16**. It will be understood that the positioning of the male and female fasteners **20** and **16** may be swapped so that the blanket rear **18** includes blanket female fasteners **16** and the blanket front **14** includes blanket male fasteners **20**, in which case, the female fastener panels **68a-d** may comprise a rear comprising the blanket female fasteners **16** and the male fastener panels **74a-c** may comprise a front comprising the blanket male fasteners **20**. Optionally, as shown in FIGS. 1-32, the blanket left side **30** is foldable relative to the blanket right side **32** to allow the blanket body **12** to wrap around and swaddle a child.

(21) Optionally, as shown in FIGS. 1-32, the female fastener **20** is a silent loop fastener and the male fastener **16** is a silent hook fastener so that attaching the female and male fasteners **16** and **20** does not awaken the child **60**.

(22) Optionally, as best seen in FIGS. 27-30, the portions of the blanket rear **18** that are aligned heightwise and widthwise with the female fastener panel fronts **70a-d** do not include a hook or loop fastener and the portions of the blanket front **14** that are aligned heightwise and widthwise with the male fastener panels rear **78a-c** do not include a hook or loop fastener—i.e., optionally, there are no loop fasteners directly in front of the hook fasteners **20** and there are no hook fasteners directly behind the loop fasteners **16**.

(23) In some embodiments, the base fabric panel **62** has the same shape and size as the blanket body **12** and the male fastener panels **74a-c** are sewn to pre-determined locations/portions of the base fabric panel rear **66**, and the female fastener panels **68a-d** are sewn to pre-determined portions of the base fabric panel front **64**. Optionally, as shown in FIGS. 1-32, the blanket thickness **22** is variable (due to the fact that in some places, the male and female fastener panels **68a-d** are sewn behind and in front of the base fabric panel **62**). Exemplary seams **100** are shown in FIGS. 27-30. It was observed silent hook and loop fasteners are a very challenging material, as once cut, they tend to release strands from the cut edge, if they are not “sealed in” or burned (as they may be 100% polyester). Thus, to reduce fraying it was advantageous to employ overlock stitching to eliminate an exposed cut edge facing out. In particular, ISO standard 605 (stitch is formed with 3-needle threads, a top cover thread and a bottom looper thread) was employed. Alternatively, the base fabric panel **62** may have cut-outs and the female and male fastener panels **68a-d** and **74a-c** may be positioned in the cut-out areas.

(24) Optionally, as shown in FIGS. 1-32, to maximize the surface area of contact between the male and female fasteners **20** and **16**, for each female fastener panel **68a-d**, the respective female fastener **16** forms/covers substantially all of the female fastener panel front **70a-d**, and for each male fastener panel **74a-c**, the respective male **20** fastener forms/covers substantially all of the male fastener panel rear **78a-c**.

(25) Optionally, as shown in FIGS. 1-32, the right side of the blanket front **14** comprises an upper female fastener panel **68a** comprising a front **70a** comprising a loop fastener **16**, a middle female fastener panel **68b** located below the upper female fastener panel **68a** and comprising a front **70b** comprising a loop fastener **16**, and a lower female fastener panel **68c** located below the middle female fastener panel **68b** and comprising a front **70c**

comprising a loop fastener **16**. Optionally, as shown in FIGS. 1-32, the left side of the swaddle blanket rear **18** comprises an upper male fastener panel **74a** aligned vertically with the upper female fastener panel **68a** and comprising a rear **78a** comprising a hook fastener **20**, a middle male fastener panel **74b** located below the upper male fastener panel **74a** and aligned vertically with the middle female fastener panel **68b** and comprising a rear **78b** comprising a hook fastener **20**, and a lower male fastener panel **74c** located below the middle male fastener panel **74b** and aligned vertically with the lower female fastener panel **68c** and comprising a rear **78c** comprising a hook fastener **20**. Optionally, as shown in FIGS. 1-32, the upper female fastener panel **68a** is the same size and shape as the upper male fastener panel **74a**, the middle female fastener panel **68b** is the same size and shape as the middle male fastener panel **74b**, and the lower female fastener panel **68c** is the same size and shape as the lower male fastener panel **74c**.

(26) Optionally, as shown in FIGS. 1-32, to allow for attachment of a band **80**, the blanket front **14** further comprises a center female fastener panel **68d** located between the upper female fastener panel **68a** and the upper male fastener panel **74a** and comprising a front **70d** comprising a loop fastener **16**. In such embodiments, as shown in FIGS. 1-32, the removable band **80** may be rectangular and may comprise a rear **82** comprising a hook fastener **98** configured to releasably attach to the loop fastener **16** of the center female fastener panel **68d**.

(27) Optionally, as shown in FIGS. 1-32, the one or more base fabric panels **62** are located between the upper female fastener panel **68a** and the middle female fastener panel **68b** and between the middle female fastener panel **68b** and the lower female fastener panel **68c** so that the female fastener panels **60a-c** are not contiguous.

(28) Optionally, as shown in FIGS. 1-32, the width **86a** of the upper female fastener panel **68a** is greater than the width **86b** of the middle female fastener panel **68b** and/or the width **86b** of the middle female fastener panel **68b** is greater than the width **86c** of the lower female fastener panel **68c**.

(29) Optionally, as shown in FIGS. 1-32, the height **90a** of the upper female fastener panel **68a** is greater than the height **90b** of the middle female fastener panel **68b** and/or the height **90c** of the lower female fastener panel **68c** is greater than the height **90b** of the middle female fastener panel **68b**.

(30) The blanket **10** may be made of any suitable material. Optionally, the base fabric panel **62**, the male fastener panels **74a-c** and the female fastener panels **68a-d** are comprised of different materials. For example, optionally, the base fabric panel **62** is comprised of modal fabric. Optionally, the male fastener panel rear **78a-c** is comprised of velvet. Optionally, the blanket female fastener panel front **70a-d** is comprised of loop fabric. It will be appreciated that other materials are possible.

(31) Optionally, as shown in FIGS. 1-32, the blanket **10** further comprises a strap **36**, which may be located adjacent (i.e., at or near) the blanket bottom **26** and may comprise a strap front **38** comprising a strap front fastener **40**, a strap rear **42** comprising a strap rear fastener **44** configured to releasably attach to the strap front fastener **40**, a strap thickness **46** extending from the strap front **38** to the strap rear **42** and parallel to the blanket thickness **22**, a strap left side **48**, a strap right side **50**, a strap width **52** extending from the strap left side **48** to the strap right side **50** and perpendicular to the strap thickness **46**, a strap top **54**, a strap bottom **56**, and/or a strap height **58** extending from the strap top **54** to the strap bottom **56** and perpendicular to the strap width **52** and the strap thickness **46** and parallel to the blanket height **28**. As shown in FIGS. 10-11A and 16-17, the strap **36** may be configured to transition from a flat position in which the strap **36** is flat to a looped position in which the strap **36** removably folds around itself and the strap front fastener **40** attaches to the strap rear fastener **44** so that the strap **36** forms a loop located in front of the blanket front **14** and/or located to the rear of the blanket rear **18** and further secures the swaddle blanket **10** around the child **60**. Optionally, as shown in FIGS. 1-32, the strap front fastener **40** is a loop fastener and further wherein the strap rear fastener **44** is a hook fastener. Optionally, as shown in FIGS. 1-32, to maximize the surface area of attachment, the strap front fastener **40** covers the strap front **38** and/or the strap rear fastener **44** covers the strap rear **42**. For example in some embodiments, the strap **36** consists merely of the strap front fastener **40** sewn to the strap rear fastener **44**. Optionally, as shown in FIGS. 1-32, the strap rear **42** is located to the rear of the blanket rear **18** in the flat position and in the looped position. Optionally, the loop is located to the rear of the blanket rear **18** in the looped position. Optionally, the strap **36** partially overlaps itself in the looped position, as shown in FIG. 11A. Optionally, as shown in FIGS. 1-32, the strap width **52** is greater than the strap height **58**. Optionally, as shown in FIGS. 1-32, the strap **36** is located below the blanket bottom **26** and the strap width **52** is greater than the blanket width **34** at the blanket bottom **26**. The strap **36** may be any suitable dimension. Optionally, as shown in FIG. 1, strap **36** is offset relative to the center of the blanket width **54**—i.e., the strap right side **50** or strap left side **48** extends a greater distance from the center of the blanket width **34** (as compared to the other side **48** or **50** of the strap **36**) to facilitate the strap **36** attaching to itself. For example, in FIG. 1, the strap left side **48** extends about 3-5 inches laterally from the blanket left side **30** whereas the strap right side **50** extends only about 0.25 inches to about 2 inches (e.g., 0.5 inches) from the blanket right side **32**. Optionally, the strap width **52** is from about 5 inches to about 10 inches and/or the strap height **58** is from about 0.5 inches to about 2 inches. Optionally, the blanket width **34** is variable and comprises a maximum width of between about 25 inches and about 35 inches. Optionally, the blanket height **28** is between about 25 inches and about 35 inches. Optionally, the blanket thickness **22** is between about 0.001 inches and about 0.5 inches.

(32) Optionally, as shown in FIGS. 1-32, except for the strap **36**, the swaddle blanket **10** is symmetrical about a longitudinal axis **94** extending from a widthwise center of the blanket top **24** to a widthwise center of the blanket bottom **26**, said longitudinal axis **94** parallel to the blanket height **28**.

(33) Optionally, as shown in FIGS. 1-32, the blanket front **14** does not have any hook fasteners **20** and/or the blanket rear **18** does not have any loop fasteners **16**.

(34) Optionally, as shown in FIGS. 1-32, one or more of the of loop fasteners **16** is aligned along the blanket height **28** with a hook fastener **20**. Preferably, except for the center female fastener panel **68d** (which attaches to the removable rectangular band **80**), each female fastener panel **68a-c** is aligned vertically with a male fastener panel **74a-c**.

(35) Optionally, as shown in FIGS. 1-32, the removable rectangular band **80** comprises a rear **82** comprising a first hook fastener **98**, and a second hook fastener **84** (i.e., a blanket attachment fastener) configured to releasably attach to a blanket loop fastener **68d**. Optionally, as shown in FIGS. 1-32, the removable rectangular band **80** comprises a front comprising a loop fastener **96** configured to releasably attach to the first hook fastener **98**. As shown in FIGS. 1-32, the removable rectangular band **80** may also include a flap **102**. Optionally, one side of the flap **102** may include a flap male fastener **104**.

(36) Optionally, as shown in FIGS. 1-32, the swaddle blanket **10** comprising a middle segment located between the blanket top **24** and blanket bottom **26**, and further wherein the blanket width **34** at the middle segment is greater than the blanket width **34** at the blanket top **24** and blanket bottom **26**. Optionally, as shown in FIGS. 1-32, the blanket width **34** at the blanket top **24** is greater than the blanket width **34** at the blanket bottom **26**.

(37) The shape of the blanket body **12** and fastener panels **68a-d** and **74a-c** of the swaddle blanket **10** shown in FIGS. 31-32 are slightly different than those of the swaddle blanket **12** shown in FIGS. 1-30.

(38) The swaddle blanket **10** may be used in any suitable method. For example, as shown in FIGS. 1-32, the swaddle blanket **10** may be used in a method that comprises a) providing the swaddle blanket **10**; b) placing a child **60** on the blanket front **14**; and c) wrapping the swaddle blanket **10** around the child **60**. Optionally, as shown in FIGS. 1-32, the method further comprises d) releasably attaching at least one male fastener panel **74a-c** to at least one blanket female fastener panel **68a-d**. Optionally, as shown in FIGS. 1-32, the method further comprises e) attaching the strap front fastener **40** to the strap rear fastener **44**. Optionally, as shown in FIGS. 10-11A and 16-17, the step of folding the blanket bottom **26** upwards towards the blanket top **24** occurs before step e).

(39) TABLE-US-00001 Part List swaddle blanket 10 blanket body 12 blanket front 14 blanket female fasteners (e.g., loop fasteners) 16 blanket rear 18 blanket male fasteners (e.g., hook fasteners) 20 blanket thickness 22 blanket top 24 blanket bottom 26 blanket height 28 blanket left side 30 blanket right side 32 blanket width 34 strap 36 strap front 38 strap front fastener 40 strap rear 42 strap rear fastener 44 strap thickness 46 strap left side 48 strap right side 50 strap width 52 strap top 54 strap bottom 56 strap height 58 child 60 base fabric panel 62 base fabric panel front 64 base fabric panel rear 66 female fastener panel (upper, middle, lower, 68a-d and center) female fastener panel front 70a-d female fastener panel rear Not shown male fastener panel (upper, middle, and lower) 74a-c male fastener panel front Not shown male fastener

panel rear 78a-c band 80 band rear 82 male band attachment fastener 84 width of female fastener panels 86a-c width of male fastener panel 88a-c height of female fastener panel (upper 90a-c middle, and lower) height of male fastener panel 92a-c longitudinal axis/centerline 94 female band fastener (loop fastener) 96 male band fastener (first hook fastener) 98 seams 100 flap 102 flap male fastener 104

(40) Those skilled in the art will understand how to make changes and modifications to the disclosed embodiments to meet their specific requirements or conditions. Changes and modifications may be made without departing from the scope and spirit of the invention. In addition, the steps of any method described herein may be performed in any suitable order and steps may be performed simultaneously if needed. Use of the singular embraces the plural.

(41) Terms of degree such as “generally”, “substantially”, “about”, and “approximately” as used herein mean a reasonable amount of deviation of the modified term such that the end result is not significantly changed. For example, these terms can be construed as including a deviation of at least ±5% of the modified term if this deviation would not negate the meaning of the word it modifies.

Claims

1. A swaddle blanket comprising: a) a blanket body comprising: i) a blanket front ii) a blanket rear; iii) a blanket thickness extending from the blanket front to the blanket rear; iv) a blanket top; v) a blanket bottom; vi) a blanket height extending from the blanket top to the blanket bottom and perpendicular to the blanket thickness; vii) a blanket left side; viii) a blanket right side; ix) a blanket width extending from the blanket left side to the blanket right side and perpendicular to the blanket height and blanket thickness; x) one or more base fabric panels comprising a front forming a portion of the blanket front and a rear forming a portion of the blanket rear; xi) a plurality of female fastener panels sewn to the front of the one or more base fabric panels, wherein at least some of the female fastener panels comprise a front forming a portion of the blanket front and comprising loop fasteners; and xii) a plurality of male fastener panels sewn to the rear of the one or more base fabric panels, wherein at least some of the male fastener panels comprise a rear forming a portion of the blanket rear and comprising hook fasteners configured to releasably attach to the loop fasteners, wherein the blanket left side is foldable relative to the blanket right side to allow the blanket body to wrap around and swaddle a child; and b) a strap located adjacent the blanket bottom and comprising a strap front comprising a strap front fastener covering the strap front, a strap rear comprising a strap rear fastener covering the strap rear configured to releasably attach to the strap front fastener, a strap thickness extending from the strap front to the strap rear and parallel to the blanket thickness, a strap left side, a strap right side, a strap width extending from the strap left side to the strap right side and perpendicular to the strap thickness, a strap top, a strap bottom, and a strap height extending from the strap top to the strap bottom and perpendicular to the strap width and the strap thickness and parallel to the blanket height, wherein one of the strap front fastener and the strap rear fastener is a hook fastener and the other of the strap front fastener and the strap rear fastener is a loop fastener, wherein the strap is configured to transition from a flat position in which the strap is flat to a looped position in which the strap removably folds around and overlaps itself and the strap front fastener attaches to the strap rear fastener so that the strap forms a loop.
2. The swaddle blanket of claim 1, wherein the plurality of female fastener panels are sewn to the front of the one or more base fabric panels via overlock stitching and the plurality of male fastener panels sewn to the rear of the one or more base fabric panels via overlock stitching.
3. The swaddle blanket of claim 1 wherein one of the strap front and the strap rear consists of loop fabric and the other of the strap front and the strap rear consists of hook fabric and further wherein the loop fabric is sewn to the hook fabric.
4. The swaddle blanket of claim 1 wherein the strap front fastener covers the strap front and/or the strap rear fastener covers the strap rear.
5. The swaddle blanket of claim 1 wherein the strap rear is located to the rear of the blanket rear in the flat position and in the looped position.
6. The swaddle blanket of claim 1 wherein the loop is located to the rear of the blanket rear in the looped position.
7. The swaddle blanket of claim 1 wherein the strap is located below the blanket bottom and further wherein the strap width is greater than the blanket width at the blanket bottom.
8. The swaddle blanket of claim 1 wherein the strap width and the blanket width each comprise a center and further wherein the center of the strap width is offset laterally relative to the center of the blanket width.
9. The swaddle blanket of claim 1 wherein one or more of the of loop fasteners is aligned along the blanket height with a hook fastener.
10. The swaddle blanket of claim 1 wherein the blanket body is symmetrical about a longitudinal axis extending from a widthwise center of the blanket top to a widthwise center of the blanket bottom, said longitudinal axis parallel to the blanket height.
11. The swaddle blanket of claim 1 wherein the hook fasteners and loop fasteners are silent hook and loop fasteners.
12. The swaddle blanket of claim 1 wherein the portions of the blanket rear that are aligned heightwise and widthwise with the female fastener panel fronts do not include a hook or loop fastener and further wherein the portions of the blanket front that are aligned heightwise and widthwise with the male fastener panel rears do not include a hook or loop fastener.
13. The swaddle blanket of claim 1, wherein for each female fastener panel, the respective loop fastener covers substantially all of the female fastener panel front, and wherein for each male fastener panel, the respective hook fastener covers substantially all of the male fastener panel rear.
14. The swaddle blanket of claim 1 wherein the right side of the blanket front comprises an upper female fastener panel comprising a front comprising a loop fastener, a middle female fastener panel located below the upper female fastener panel and comprising a front comprising a loop fastener, and a lower female fastener panel located below the middle female fastener panel and comprising a front comprising a loop fastener.
15. The swaddle blanket of claim 14 wherein the left side of the blanket rear comprises an upper male fastener panel aligned vertically with the upper female fastener panel and comprising a rear comprising a hook fastener, a middle male fastener panel located below the upper male fastener panel and aligned vertically with the middle female fastener panel and comprising a rear comprising a hook fastener, and a lower male fastener panel located below the middle male fastener panel and aligned vertically with the lower female fastener panel and comprising a rear comprising a hook fastener.
16. The swaddle blanket of claim 15 wherein the upper female fastener panel is the same size and shape as the upper male fastener panel, wherein the middle female fastener panel is the same size and shape as the middle male fastener panel, and further wherein the lower female fastener panel is the same size and shape as the lower male fastener panel.
17. The swaddle blanket of claim 15 wherein the blanket front further comprises a center female fastener panel located between the upper female fastener panel and the upper male fastener panel and comprising a front comprising a loop fastener.
18. The swaddle blanket of claim 17 further comprising a removable rectangular band comprising a rear comprising a hook fastener configured to releasably attach to the loop fastener of the center female fastener panel.
19. The swaddle blanket of claim 15 wherein the one or more base fabric panels is located between the upper female fastener panel and the middle female fastener panel, and between the middle female fastener panel and the lower female fastener panel.
20. The swaddle blanket of claim 15 wherein the width of the upper female fastener panel is greater than the width of the middle female fastener panel and further wherein the width of the middle female fastener panel is greater than the width of the lower female fastener panel.
21. The swaddle blanket of claim 15 wherein the height of the upper female fastener panel is greater than the height of the middle female fastener panel and/or the height of the lower female fastener panel is greater than the height of the middle female fastener panel.
22. The swaddle blanket of claim 1 wherein the blanket front does not have any hook fasteners and the blanket rear does not have any loop fasteners.
23. The swaddle blanket of claim 1 wherein the plurality of female fastener panels and the plurality of male fastener panels are comprised of a different material than the one or more base fabric panels.

